

THE UNSHAKEN SELF

Book Club Kit

A 9-session reading schedule, 20 discussion questions, and a study glossary for groups reading the book together.

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How to Use This Kit

The Unshaken Self maps all 18 chapters of the Bhagavad Gita onto modern life. This kit is built for reading groups covering the book over nine sessions, two chapters at a time — though it flexes easily to a slower or faster pace.

Each session: read the two assigned chapters beforehand, try at least one of their Daily Practices during the week, then use the matching questions below (and the group prompts) to discuss. Fill in dates and a rotating facilitator as your group plans its schedule.

SUGGESTED 9-SESSION SCHEDULE

Session	Chapters	Focus	Date	Facilitator
1	1-2	When Life Freezes You · You Are Not Your Thoughts		
2	3-4	Do It Because It Matters · The Fire That Cleans		
3	5-6	Free in a Busy World · The Quietest Room Is Inside You		
4	7-8	Seeing the Thread · What You Remember Last, Shapes You First		
5	9-10	The Simplest Secret · Spotting Greatness Everywhere		
6	11-12	The Bigger Picture · Love as a Daily Verb		
7	13-14	The Watcher and the Garden · The Three Colours of Your Mood		
8	15-16	The Upside-Down Tree · The Two Wolves Inside You		
9	17-18	You Become What You Believe · The Open Door		

20 Discussion Questions

One question per chapter, plus two questions for the group to discuss once the whole book is finished.

Ch. 1 — When Life Freezes You

Arjuna freezes before he learns anything. Have you ever needed to be "stuck" before you could grow? What finally moved you?

Ch. 2 — You Are Not Your Thoughts

The chapter separates the changing mind from a steady awareness behind it. Does that distinction feel true to your own experience, or too abstract to be useful?

Ch. 3 — Do It Because It Matters

Karma Yoga asks for full effort with released attachment to outcome. Where in your life is that easiest to practise? Where is it hardest?

Ch. 4 — The Fire That Cleans

What is one belief the group collectively holds that might be worth "burning away"?

Ch. 5 — Free in a Busy World

Renunciation here means an open hand, not an empty life. What are you holding too tightly right now?

Ch. 6 — The Quietest Room Is Inside You

What has stopped you, personally, from sustaining a meditation practice — and did this chapter change that?

Ch. 7 — Seeing the Thread

Share one connection in your life you hadn't noticed until this chapter pointed at it.

Ch. 8 — What You Remember Last, Shapes You First

What does your mind actually dwell on right before sleep, most nights? Is that on purpose?

Ch. 9 — The Simplest Secret

What's a truth you've "known" for years but never actually practised?

Ch. 10 — Spotting Greatness Everywhere

Who in your own life is quietly remarkable in a way you rarely say out loud?

Ch. 11 — The Bigger Picture

Does zooming out make your current problems feel smaller — or does it risk making them feel like they don't matter at all? Discuss the difference.

Ch. 12 — Love as a Daily Verb

Bhakti is framed as action, not feeling. Do you agree love should be practised even when the feeling isn't there?

Ch. 13 — The Watcher and the Garden

Try, out loud, describing a current stress as something happening "in the field" rather than "to me." Does the language shift anything?

Ch. 14 — The Three Colours of Your Mood

Which guna — sattva, rajas, or tamas — has the group noticed most in itself this month, and why?

Ch. 15 — The Upside-Down Tree

What are you currently "rooted" in? Has that root changed over the years?

Ch. 16 — The Two Wolves Inside You

Which wolf got fed more in your household or workplace this week?

Ch. 17 — You Become What You Believe

Pick one belief you've never examined. Where did it actually come from?

Ch. 18 — The Open Door

Does the book's version of freedom — full engagement, not withdrawal — match or challenge what you thought freedom meant before reading it?

Whole-Book Questions

19. Across all eighteen chapters, which single Daily Practice have you actually kept doing — and which did you drop? Why?
20. The book argues that a 5,000-year-old text can address modern burnout, anxiety, and distraction. Where did that argument convince you, and where did it feel like a stretch?

Study Notes — Key Terms

A short glossary of Sanskrit terms that come up often in group discussion. The full 18-term glossary lives in the 18 Chapters Study Companion.

Term	Meaning
<i>Kurukshetra</i>	The battlefield of the Gita; symbolically, any place an inner conflict must be faced.
<i>Sthitaprajna</i>	One of steady wisdom, undisturbed by praise, blame, gain, or loss.
<i>Nishkama Karma</i>	Action performed without attachment to its fruits.
<i>Sannyasa</i>	Renunciation — here, an inner letting-go rather than a literal departure from life.
<i>Dhyana</i>	Sustained, focused meditation.
<i>Bhakti</i>	Devotion; love expressed through consistent action.
<i>Guna</i>	Quality — the three qualities (sattva, rajas, tamas) that colour every state of mind.
<i>Moksha</i>	Liberation; freedom that is fully engaged with life, not withdrawn from it.

FACILITATOR NOTES

There are no wrong answers to a reflection question — the aim of each session is honest sharing, not correct interpretation. If a chapter's practice didn't work for someone, that's as worth discussing as a practice that did.

Consider closing each session with one round: everyone names one thing, in one sentence, they are taking into the coming week.